

Whistleblowing Policy

SECTIONS 1-4: PURPOSE, SCOPE, RESPONSIBILITIES & REPORTING PROCEDURE

1 PURPOSE

To encourage staff and others to raise concerns about poor practice, wrongdoing or risks to children without fear of victimisation, in line with the Protected Disclosures Act, Children First and Tusla best practice.

2 SCOPE

- ✓ All staff, volunteers, contractors and agency workers
- ✓ Concerns about child safety, malpractice, policy breaches or illegal acts
- ✓ Internal and external reporting routes
- ✓ Protection and support for the person raising the concern

3 RESPONSIBILITIES

- ✓ **Provider & PIC:** Foster open culture and protect whistleblowers
- ✓ **Designated Whistleblowing Officer:** Receive and manage concerns
- ✓ **All Staff:** Raise concerns promptly in good faith
- ✓ **Management:** Investigate fairly and without delay
- ✓ **Registered Provider:** Ultimate oversight and accountability

4 REPORTING PROCEDURE

- ✓ Multiple confidential reporting routes clearly publicised
- ✓ Concerns acknowledged and investigated promptly
- ✓ Protection from detriment guaranteed
- ✓ Feedback given where possible without breaching confidentiality
- ✓ Records maintained securely

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SECTIONS 5-7: PROTECTION, SUPPORT & OUTCOMES

5 PROTECTION FOR WHISTLEBLOWERS

- ✓ No victimisation or disadvantage for raising concerns in good faith
- ✓ Anonymity respected where possible
- ✓ Legal protection explained
- ✓ Support offered during and after the process
- ✓ Malicious reporting addressed fairly

6 SUPPORT MEASURES

- Access to counselling or independent advice
- Regular updates on progress of investigation
- Support for all parties involved
- Learning shared organisation-wide where appropriate
- Culture of openness actively promoted

7 OUTCOMES & ACTIONS

- Appropriate action taken on substantiated concerns
- Lessons learned incorporated into policy and training
- Serious concerns escalated externally when required
- Record of outcome maintained
- Feedback to the whistleblower where possible

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SECTIONS 8-10: TRAINING, MONITORING & POLICY REVIEW

8 TRAINING & COMPLIANCE

- ✓ All staff receive whistleblowing awareness training
- ✓ Policy prominently displayed and accessible
- ✓ Compliance monitored through supervision
- ✓ Immediate action on any retaliation
- ✓ Records kept in line with GDPR

9 MONITORING & REVIEW

- ✓ Audits of concerns raised and outcomes
- ✓ Feedback from staff on confidence in the process
- ✓ Analysis of themes and trends
- ✓ Effectiveness of protection measures assessed
- ✓ Annual report to management

10 POLICY REVIEW

- ✓ Reviewed annually or sooner if required
- ✓ Incorporates feedback, incidents and legal updates
- ✓ Considers culture and reporting trends
- ✓ Reviewed policy approved by Registered Provider and communicated to all staff
- ✓ Superseded versions archived per record management procedures